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‘When we lose these destination businesses, it’s like cutting the main roots.’

SCOTT MATALON, *president, Allston Village Main Streets*



CHRISTIAN KANTOSKY FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Among the changes in Allston, there was even a rumor about the fate of mainstay Blanchard’s liquor store.

A shift on Harvard Ave.

Allston watches warily as businesses along main route change — or disappear

By Karyna Cheung
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

The onetime home of Allston’s legendary Great Scott music venue is now a Taco Bell. The former Twin Donuts is becoming Boston’s newest Blank Street Coffee. On Harvard Avenue, decades-long tenants of the Gordon building are fleeing steep rent increases.

The area in Allston surrounding Harvard Avenue — a core of college life — is experiencing jarring change. The commercial district has seen more business closings this year than at any time since the COVID-19 shutdown.

It’s mostly smaller, locally owned businesses closing, with few clues on what will

replace them. Even for Great Scott, plans to revive the historic venue are stalled because of rising construction costs.

The trend has community leaders and remaining local owners worried that the neighborhood’s local, youth-driven, artistic character is seeping away.

“When we lose these destination businesses, it’s like cutting the main roots,” Allston Village Main Streets president Scott Matalon said. “They feed the rest of the neighborhood.”

It’s a dilemma other neighborhoods have faced. Boston’s rising real estate values mean retail space is increasingly pricey. Landlords often charge substantially more than long-

time tenants are paying — and that trend only accelerates as existing owners cash out.

Allston, affectionately known as “Rat City” by residents for the innumerable rodents living among them, is no exception.

There are rumors, too, of Blanchard’s liquor store closing, originating from a now-deleted Reddit post.

Chris Corey, owner of the decades-old Allston establishment on Harvard and Brighton avenues, has not responded to multiple requests for comment, including a call where he abruptly hung up on a Globe reporter.

Uncertainty and unease over Allston’s commercial future have escalated since the

ALLSTON, Page A7

Tricky treks can mean steep bills for hikers needing help in New Hampshire

State is one of few that will charge for mountain rescues

By Ariela Lopez
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

A recent rescue of four teenage hikers on Franconia Ridge in the White Mountains has sparked wide interest, but less so for the drama of the nighttime operation and more so for the fact that New Hampshire intends to bill them for the cost.

A 2015 New Hampshire law allows the state Fish and Game Department to bill rescued hikers who

are determined “to have acted negligently” by failing to prepare for their trek. The state is one of just a few — including Maine, Oregon, and California — where agencies can seek to recover the cost of a rescue operation from the person or group who needed it.

Colonel Kevin Jordan, who leads the department’s law enforcement arm, called the case to bill the teens an “obvious” one, based on their apparent lack of preparation. The four 18-year-olds embarked on a strenuous hike that can take upwards of seven hours to complete at 3:30 p.m. without packing headlamps, warm clothing, or enough water. About

five hours in, they called for help.

“They didn’t know where they were,” Jordan said in a phone interview this week. “It was pretty bad.”

Advik Yadav, one of the rescued hikers, said in an interview with NBC 4 New York he was grateful to the rescuers who spent nearly eight hours guiding them back to the trailhead before 9 the next morning.

“You should start, like, really early, so it’s not dark when you go down, and you shouldn’t be very overconfident,” Tirth Shah, another rescued hiker, told the television station.

Jainam Bhavsar, a third hiker, de-

HIKERS, Page A6

Color us honored: Pair of plaids mark Scots’ visit

2 groups celebrate Boston with tartans

By Camilo Fonseca
GLOBE STAFF

Boston couldn’t get enough of Scottish World Cup fans. The Tartan Army drank the town dry, crowned statues with traffic cones, and bravely whooshed down the “cop slide” in kilts.

The admiration was mutual — and strong enough that Mayor Michelle Wu announced plans to make Boston and Glasgow sister cities. Susan Aitken, leader of the Glasgow City Council, called the move “a fantastic gesture from our friends in Boston.”

Now Boston and the Scots will be further intertwined.

A shopping mall in Glasgow unveiled its own bespoke tartan, the traditional woven fabric used for kilts and shawls, in honor of the city’s “twinning” with Boston. A ceremonial

kilt made with the new tartan will be presented to Boston when the two cities celebrate their agreement, Buchanan Galleries said in a statement last week. The event, dubbed “Tartan Day,” is expected to take place in April.

“The presentation will formally celebrate the long and storied history between Glasgow and Boston as two major North Atlantic port cities over the last four hundred years, while recognizing the role Scotland supporters played in bringing the two cities even closer together during the recent FIFA World Cup,” read the statement.

But while the Buchanan Galleries tartan may have the endorsement of Scotland’s largest city, it’s not the only design to honor the Tartan Army’s hosts across the pond.

TARTAN, Page A10



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF/FILE

During the World Cup games at Foxborough, fans in tartan kilts were a common sight in Boston. Now there are two tartans celebrating the city.

Doctor testifies on words to children

Clancy told them ‘Go to God’ during killings

By Shelley Murphy and Lea Skene
GLOBE STAFF

This story may contain content readers find disturbing or triggering.

PLYMOUTH — For the first time in the triple murder trial of Lindsay Clancy, jurors heard what she said to her children before killing them.

“Go to God.”

The chilling scene was described by a psychiatrist testifying for the prosecution on Friday, who said Clancy described the murder scene when he interviewed her in custody several months ago.

The psychiatrist, Dr. Avram Mack, testified as an expert witness for the prosecution. He was hired by the Plymouth district attorney’s office to evaluate Clancy’s claim she was suffering from postpartum psychosis.

His testimony came from two interviews of Clancy at Tewksbury Hospital in April. (Separately, in a civil lawsuit she filed against her practitioners, Clancy acknowledged using the same phrase during the killings.)

Clancy has admitted she strangled 5-year-old Cora, 3-year-old Dawson, and 8-month-old Callan after sending her husband out to pick up medication and takeout for dinner. She then slashed her neck and wrists and jumped out a second-story window in a failed suicide attempt. She is para-

CLANCY, Page A7

For Lynch, a challenge in the 8th District

Roath drawing eyes ahead of Democratic primary

By Anjali Huynh
GLOBE STAFF

To active Democrats in Boston and its southern suburbs, the primary for the Eighth Congressional District is one of the most exciting races in years: Voters’ mailboxes are filling with campaign fliers, and at a time when dissatisfaction with long-serving incumbents is running high, some polls show the challenger closing in.

You just wouldn’t know it from watching the incumbent, Stephen Lynch, actually campaign.

“We’re in good shape,” the South Boston Democrat said last week, smiling with confidence and nonchalance after a candidate forum in Weymouth, his first with challenger Patrick Roath this cycle. “I think we’ll be happy with the result.”

For Lynch, 71, a contested primary is not new. But Roath, a 39-year-old attorney and former Deval Patrick aide, is trying to exploit a restive Democratic base anxious for fresh voices in Washington, accusing the more moderate Lynch of clinging to “politics of the past” and aiming to energize voters in ways his progressive predecessors hadn’t — de-

PRIMARY, Page A10



Summer drip

Saturday: Cloudy, showers.
High: 68-73. Low: 62-67.

Sunday: Cloudy, humid.
High: 73-78. Low: 64-69.

Sunrise: 5:59 Sunset: 7:35

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